



Greece



Torchbearers also carry an olive branch, a symbol of peace.

Olympic torch

The Olympic Games started in ancient Greece. Today, a torch is lit at Olympia, near Pirgos, and a series of runners carry it through Greece before a similar relay in the host country and city.



Kalamata olives

Purple olives grow on kalamata trees in southern Greece. They are handpicked and preserved in olive oil.

Athens's city

Athens, the capital of Greece, takes its name from the ancient Greek goddess Athena. Today, remains of the old civilization can still be seen in the modern city.

The Parthenon temple stands at the top of an ancient site called the Acropolis, which overlooks Athens.



Ancient Greece was one of the **first great civilizations** of **Europe**, where people prayed to the **gods** of **Mount Olympus**. Today, **tourists** flock to this **Mediterranean country** to see its **ancient ruins** and explore its **thousands of beautiful islands**. The country's **economy** depends largely on **tourism** and **shipping**.



- 📏 50,948 sq miles (131,957 sq km)
- 👤 10.6 million
- ★ Athens
- 🗨️ Greek, other languages (+2)